



Monty Kosma

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Quick summary:

- Career arc: physicist, CTO, attorney, McKinsey consultant, COO, CEO, Head of Product, independent consultant, Co-Founder, Founder & CEO
- Geo: Connecticut -> Los Angeles -> Kansas City -> Chicago -> DC -> SF -> Houston -> Austin
- Family: ~~creating love & connection every day with Susanna~~; love my 5 boys men who are now men creating their own unique paths in the world; ~~excited to have four new young 'uns in my life, thanks to Susanna~~; happily divorced from Deanna, and now we're better friends

Big ideas & current interests:

- The nature of Connection between people, interests, and ideas
- Construction projects as nonlinear systems "gang aft agley"
- Pushing and pulling prodigious quantities of iron

Consulting work:

- I'm an independent consultant who helps tech and telecom leaders execute their most important cross-functional initiatives, particularly where big data, IoT, and operations research are involved
- Sample projects:



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- Advising the CEO of a construction tech firm on strategic business development
- Helping develop investor and market communications for a home care technology startup caring and curing loneliness for adults with developmental disabilities
- Helping the board of directors of a multi-billion-dollar company understand IoT, cloud technology, and recurring revenue P&L models
- Building and optimizing a plan for acquiring the spectrum footprint to support a new greenfield 5G network covering >85% of the US population.
- Developing product requirements and functional spec for a new logistics system for a manufacturer of radioactive pharmaceutical products with a half-life measured in minutes

- See <http://strategality.com> for my consulting bio

Blog:

- Does not exist - yet!



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a means to redefining the performance envelope

- Diversification of risk, career paths, resumes
- Why are Contacts so fucked up?
 - Why is LinkedIn so fucked up?
 - Why is Google Contacts so fucked up?
 - Why is Apple Contacts so fucked up?
 - Why can't FANG unfuck Contacts?
 - Contacts+ and minuses
 - Note to self: STOP WHINING! ayayay.ai, cantay no llores (aka nerdherding)
- The Law and Economics of Love / Relationships (may have to be a book)
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Projects:

- Solved the world's largest computational problem, together with lifelong friend Dan Aronson. However, Danny Hillis took credit for it publicly. I think I have a good case that he owes me a tasty beverage, at least. See NY Times, Nov. 25, 1990, § 1 at 1, available at <https://www.nytimes.com/1990/11/25/us/future-of-big-computing-a-victory-for-lilliputians.html>

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- Co-founded The Green Bag: An Entertaining Journal of Law, together with my close friend Ross E. Davies who is now (arguably) the most interesting law professor in America. The Green Bag is one of the top 5 law journals in the world, is sometimes cited by the US Supreme Court, but is mostly famous for our series of Supreme Court Bobbleheads. I spoke with Michele Norris about their origins and Nina Totenberg's story about the time Rehnquist scolded her for chewing gum in the courtroom. All Things Considered, Oct. 27, 2003.



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in 2001 before it was cool. <http://tinyking.net>

- Measured the relative influence of Justices of the US Supreme Court, publishing a peer-reviewed big data analysis of the citation patterns in millions of federal court opinions. Settled the long-running debate (IMHO) between David Currie, Frank Easterbrook, and others over who was the Most Insignificant Justice.
 - http://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=1410280
 - <http://www.washingtonpost.com/wp-dyn/content/article/2010/04/23/AR2010042302226.html>
 - <https://www.investors.com/politics/commentary/supreme-court-justice-investment/>

Stories:

- I got to ride with Richard Feynman in his famous [van](#), and spent a bunch of hours with the man. He inspired me to take a path through life of diving deeply into everything that sparks my curiosity.





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real joker and a religious freedom scholar, advised me, “just say *Employment Divison v Smith*” when Scalia popped the inevitable question. (For those non-lawyers out there, *Smith* was a Scalia majority opinion holding that a facially neutral law prohibiting the use of peyote did not violate the First Amendment even though it was designed to and in fact did single out and prohibit a religious practice.) Silly joke, as there were about 100 better answers to the question. But in my interview, sure enough, Justice Scalia asked the question, and my mind instantly went blank ... and I found myself saying, *Employment Division v. Smith*. It just came out. His jaw dropped. Literally, his mouth hung open. “Now that’s a bold answer, Mr. Kosma! Explain yourself.” I couldn’t believe I said it, didn’t have the presence of mind to laugh it off as a bad joke, or even to blame my cursed co-clerk Seeger. (I felt better when I learned that Peter Thiel also screwed up a Scalia interview, though I bet his story isn’t as funny.) Perhaps one day I should smoke some peyote in memory of late Justice Scalia.

- I was there when Michael Jackson’s hair caught on fire. I was parking cars at the Shrine Auditorium for the Pepsi shoot and was



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been Miguel Estrada and Elliot Noss.

PRs:

- Leg press: 500lbs (3 x 10)
- More TBD

Favorite Books:

- Elizabeth Lesser, Broken Open: How Difficult Times Can Help Us Grow.
<https://www.amazon.com/Broken-Open-Difficult-Times-Help/dp/0375759913>
- Nicholas Nassim Taleb, Antifragile: Things That Gain From Disorder.
<https://www.amazon.com/Antifragile-Things-That-Disorder-Incerto/dp/0812979680/ref=nodl>
- Cixin Liu, The Three Body Problem.
<https://www.amazon.com/Three-Body-Problem-Cixin-Liu/dp/0765382032>
- Vernor Vinge, A Deepness In The Sky.
<https://www.amazon.com/Deepness-Sky-Zones-Thought/dp/0812536355>

Favorite Quotes:

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Ideas:

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Teaching / Tutorials:

- Taught a seminar for about a dozen federal judges on the law and economics of data mining and digital privacy

Music:

- Play a bit of ukulele, bass guitar, regular guitar, piano, sax, and trumpet. But mostly I just whistle.
- Long-standing and still favorite bands are



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three short films as part of Epsilon Eridani Productions and the 48 Hour Film Project. See, e.g.,

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZHbLNZYzsDo>.

- Won my first record album, Point of No Return by Kansas, in sixth grade by entering a Juvenile Diabetes Foundation art contest. Drew a spaceship with aliens landing on Earth and giving us the cure to diabetes. I don't believe this has actually happened yet.
- Played bass in an LA punk band back in the mid-1980s - so punk we didn't have a name.

Volunteering:

- Head of Infrastructure & Build, Camp Infinite Love
- Black Rock Ranger, Burning Man
- Formerly, Gate Perimeter & Exodus, Lighthouse (Radar operator), Burning Man
- Formerly, Executive Editor of The Green Bag